

PERSUASION

The Practice of Influence

What Everyone Ought To Know About
The Psychology of Persuasion



Jane Cialdini and Robert Austin

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Persuasion: The Practice Of Influence

What Everyone Ought to Know About the
Psychology of Persuasion. Become an
Influencer without Authority by
Understanding the Science and Genetic Code
of People

Written By

Jane Cialdini and Robert Austen

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Introduction

In life, anywhere you look, there are chances to be persuaded. Whether it is the billboard you pass on your way to work, the person you text most often, or even the lover with whom you share children, these things and people can be influential and persuasive. You may have already identified obvious forms of persuasion, and maybe that is how you landed on this book. While it is important to know how others may be influencing you, it is an entirely different concept to figure out how to influence others.

Persuasion and influence are an art, and like art, they take practice. After you have completed this reading, you will better understand persuasion. However, you may not be able to go out and convince everyone of what you want them to do right away. It takes time, but if you stay committed to your goals and dedicated to your intentions, you will become a master persuader in no time.

The aim of persuasion is not to manipulate but to bring people to decisions that are in their best interest and to help further worthwhile causes. These are causes that are beneficial and bring value to society. While you will most likely benefit from the persuasion tactics in which you choose to partake, you should ensure that they are beneficial for other parties involved as well.

If you continue to take from people but never give back, this behavior may haunt you one day. Persuasion and influence should be viewed in a positive light as tools that help people, not as a means of hurting others.

The foundation for the practice of influence and persuasion is understanding human psychology, how people make decisions, and how they are wired. Everyone is different, so the ways that you decide to persuade them will differ as well. If you are knowledgeable about psychology, you will have an easier time differentiating individuals and understanding what persuasion tactics are best used on them.

From there, techniques and practices can be pursued sincerely. If you are genuine with intention and actually want to help people, it will be easy to adopt the methods and strategies of some excellent influencers and persuaders. Remember that it is going to take some trial and error, and not everyone will agree with your viewpoint right away. Make sure that you are in a mindset where you are ready to take criticism and willing to accept the fact that some people just will not be persuaded.

Learning starts by making sure that you are aware of the power of influence and persuasion. They can be harmful tools if they are put into the wrong hands, and as you are reading these words, a few people probably come to mind right away. In order to ensure that you are not using these methods of influence improperly, we are going to take you through negative stereotypes to ensure that you are not someone who is going to take advantage of anyone.

When used correctly, persuasion and influence can elicit positive change in groups of people rather than just from individual to individual. Connecting with people on a general level and determining mutual interests will be helpful in ensuring you are someone who can easily persuade others.

When you understand that these methods can be very helpful in your life, you can start to learn ways in which you can implement the best practices into your everyday activity. There are many benefits and advantages to being a persuasive person. The most obvious one is that you will be better at getting what you want.

From there, you will realize that you have more confidence, which can seriously reduce stress and anxiety. By reducing these things alone, you are going to feel much better; you will have the power needed to be the person you have always wanted to be.

It is important to know the difference between influence and persuasion. They are related, and you cannot have one without the other. However, the terms are not interchangeable. One means a specific moment, and the other is in reference to a more prolonged period of encouragement. This book will lay the groundwork and understandings of each so you can create your own personalized methods of persuasion and influence to help you achieve the goals you may have been ignoring.

Once you learn how to be persuasive, you will most likely be happier altogether. Instead of sitting silently in the background, you will be able to use your voice to speak up for what matters. Though it might seem scary at times, you are going to become the person you have always admired; an influential and inspirational leader who knows what it takes to be successful. Your confidence will keep building over time, especially the more you practice refining your skills.

Examples are provided, but remember to apply the methods and techniques specifically to your situation. We are all different, and our levels of expertise differ as well. You will be confronting those you wish to persuade, so ensure that you are personalizing your strategies to your individual life. That is what being a persuasive influencer is all about!

Chapter 1 – The Awesome Power of Being Persuasive and Influential

You can only use influence and persuasion when you have been influenced or persuaded in the past. To understand how to use something properly, you normally have to have been on the opposite side. Thus, you are able to see the full power. You can understand the damage of the dark side of persuasion—manipulation—and feel the pain that it can cause.

When persuasion is done correctly, however, you also know how beneficial it can be. Remember when your parents tried to persuade you to follow one form of schooling over another? You may have ignored their advice, or perhaps you took it and ended up finding success in that specific field. When you can see the benefits of persuasion, you know how to better use it so that you are helping others and not hurting them.

Before getting into how to become persuasive/influential and emphasizing the power that comes along with it, one must consider why someone wants to be persuasive in the first place. Do you feel as though you are lacking power? Or would you rather just gain control over others?

Before getting into the psychology of how someone might become influential, you have to first look at what it takes to make someone motivated to become persuasive in the first place. You have to pursue it for the right reasons. Once you understand that persuasion and influence will greatly help you, it is much easier to take on the roles and responsibilities rather than trying to use these methods to gain control and power over someone else.

Do you want to have power at work, where you can be assured that you will get away with whatever you want? It can be exhausting to work for someone who takes advantage of you. When we feel as though we are being walked all over, it can cause us to lose interest in our position. When someone takes more from us than they are giving back, it can be a lonely feeling and one from which it is hard to recover.

In order to make sure you are getting the most out of your position and that you are taking your career in the right direction, you have to ensure that you have persuasive techniques that make you appear reliable, trustworthy, and deserving of more. When you are able to achieve this reality, it becomes much easier to start getting what you wanted and deserved from the beginning.

Perhaps you are concerned about not having enough power with friends, family, or in your relationship. Sometimes others can take advantage of us, much like our bosses. The person you lie next to in bed every night could also be responsible for your constant stress and worry due to them asking too much from you.

If you know what you want but do not know how to say it, you can use persuasive techniques to try and get them to follow your path toward happiness. It is not something that is malicious but rather a way for you to encourage someone to do something that you know is best for them.

Many people take advantage of their abilities to persuade people and try to gain too much control over others. Instead, you can learn how to unlock an ability that already exists inside of you so you can take charge of your life.

You should never intentionally try to control someone, but when you know how to sway them in a direction that is in your favor, in the end, it can help you both. Other people might need some pushing every now and then because they do not have the courage to make the right decision.

Persuasion is a form of encouragement that helps unlock parts of one's life with some outside sources, while still helping them go in their own direction. Persuasion should never be a method of force. Instead, emphasis should be placed on using your persuasive abilities for good.

Advantages of Being Both Persuasive and Influential

The biggest benefit of having influence is the ability to express your wants and needs. Sometimes you may not know how to properly let another person know what you want from them. Instead of saying something that

could either hurt them or be damaging to the relationship, you instead decide to persuade them to get what you want.

When you have influence over someone, you can help others fulfill their needs too, especially if you are helping someone who might be lost or has no direction. Everyone is responsible for making their own decisions, but sometimes people need encouragement or at least a small push in the right direction.

You can better communicate your needs in a relationship. The other person could be hypersensitive, or maybe they do not know how to express their needs either. Positive influence from you can make an impact on them, and then the two of you can help each other grow. If you had decided to use persuasion, you could both be avoiding each other and not saying what is really on your mind or expressing feelings that need to be worked on. It might seem like you are avoiding your problems, but when you build a good relationship from a mutual positive influence, you will get to a place where communication becomes easier.

At work, you can finally start getting what you want. Sometimes, we become a “yes man,” or someone who just takes orders and does what they are told. At first, it is easier to do. Instead of having to confront people, we just say yes because doing the task is easier than trying to get out of it.

After a while, however, it can become draining. Suddenly everyone is constantly asking for our help, and before we know it, we are exhausted due to taking on too many projects at once. When we use persuasion rather than authority, it can help us get what we want without having to be forceful in a negative way.

Instead of rudely telling someone no, we just have to persuade them to give the project to someone else or use other influential tactics that help alleviate the pressure that was put on us in the first place.

When you tell people what to do, they sometimes end up doing the opposite. If you tell people not to touch something, it makes people want to touch it even more. If you say, “Don’t look!”, people look immediately. Some people are naturally insubordinate, and other people do not think about your request directly.

If you forcefully tell someone to do something, it might encourage them to do the opposite. Persuasion and influence can help because you are still sending them off in the right direction to do what you want them to do, but you are skipping the part where they potentially say no or run and do the opposite.

Create a Better World

Persuasive speakers can help influence more than just one person at a time. Instead of sharing your positive ideas and helpful mindset to one person, if you are skilled at persuasion, you can influence groups of people at a time. The world needs positive influencers. We are desperate for role models, especially when you look at some of the most popular people in the world today.

If you have what it takes to be someone who can elicit positive change, it is important that you know how to be persuasive and influential. You are already an inspiration, but now it is time to grow your sharing skills and sharpen your ability to spread new thoughts and ideas to other individuals.

Persuading groups of people to do things is more challenging, and not everyone is able to do it. Most of the time, the most influential people are that way on accident, whether they are doing good or spreading bad perspectives. When you really practice your persuasion skills and grow to become an admirable and influential person, you can have the ability to step in as the leader that many people need.

Since people learn in different ways, it is important to know how to be persuasive in a way that everyone understands. When complete understanding occurs, amazing things can happen. You may not think that it is possible, but if you continue to practice your influencing skills and grow your ability to persuade, you can become very powerful.

You can better the lives of others by encouraging them to do the right thing. Many motivational speakers are influencers and have the ability to persuade. They know what it takes to be happy because they are living a life for which they worked hard.

If you are someone who is living your dream, is happy with where you are, and is equipped with the tools to combat the challenges in life, you are certainly one of a kind. If you add persuasive skills on top of all that, you can start teaching other people how to live like you, making the world a better place overall.

If you simply tell everyone what to do, they don't necessarily want to listen. Persuasion is on a personal level, with skilled tricks to get people to buy into who you are in order for them to be influenced by what you have to say.

Even when your persuasion fails, you have still offered information that may have caused people to think differently. Sometimes you won't be able to convince another person to change, and you won't have the ability to cause them to gain a new perspective. What you will have done, however, is caused them to think.

You forced them into a place where they had to confront their own feelings and make judgments based on their beliefs. Even if you didn't convince them about what you had intended when you first started persuading them, you still got them thinking, and in the end, that can be the most influential factor of all. It is not always going to be what you wanted when you set out to influence, but it is still a positive result.

Help People

When you see someone who might not have the courage to stand up for themselves, your persuasive tactics can come in handy. With these techniques, you can convince those who are taking advantage of a person or situation to stop. You can help encourage the victim to stand up for themselves by persuading them to speak their mind when they are feeling low.

When you have a positive influence on those who need it, you fulfill their lives while filling a part of yours as well. Some people are more susceptible to influence than others, so it is important that you step in as someone positive rather than wait around for easily influenced people to get taken advantage of by someone who might be a master manipulator.

When done right, persuasion and influence can be a form of problem solving. If you have to confront a group of people that is set in their ways, it might be hard to tell them otherwise.

Instead of listening to what you have to say that might fix the problem, they will instead find ways to prove you wrong and discredit whatever it is you might be trying to convince them of doing. If you use a subtler method of persuasion and influential tactics to show why your way is better, it can help encourage them to make the decision themselves rather than latch onto the opposition with a more combative strategy.

Other people who see your positive influence can start to change their ways too. We think of babies as mimicking everything they see, but this mimicking can occur all the way through adulthood. If you live a lifestyle in which you help people, others will start to follow along.

By persuading others to help, they will end up persuading more people to help too. Manipulation can easily spread from person to person as it is a learned trait and sometimes a survival tool. If you spin the situation positively and encourage people to do what is best for them, as well as for you, it will be much more powerful than it would have been if it led to abusive manipulative behavior.

Some people are set in their ways but being influential offers them a different perspective. Imagine a world where we didn't have positive influencers who were willing to change their thoughts. We would still live in a world where sexism, racism, and homophobia were all acceptable social acts.

Positive influencers encourage change, and without them, many people would still be set in their ways. When one person's mindset changes for the better, they have figured out a method of living that is more beneficial than how they were living before. They can then help others "see the light," or live a better life if they persuade them to start thinking the same way.

Ethical Foundation for Using Persuasion and Influence Strategies

Since persuasion and influence are powerful tools, you must be careful with how you use them. They are tools, just like any other item you would pick up to use for a task. A knife can be useful to cook and help prepare a delicious meal, but it can also be used to fatally stab someone.

When you aren't careful with who you are persuading or how you might be doing so, you can alter things for the worse. When persuasion turns negative, it can become manipulation, which can be damaging to many different people. Some individuals are more sensitive to influence than others, which may result in them getting taken advantage of by the manipulator.

If you are taking from someone else, then you have to question your ethics with your method of persuasion. People should think for themselves, but some people have moments where they aren't able to easily do so. Just because we might not have those same moments of weakness does not mean that we should be taking advantage of them.

Humans are entitled to free choice. When we take that freedom away from someone, are we really getting what we want? Are you really fulfilled if you take something from another person?

When you manipulate and control someone too much, they start to lose their identity. They are no longer themselves and have become a version of you, scared to displease you or not live up to a certain standard. When this shift in identity happens, it can be hard to recover.

Not only is it a bad situation for the person who was manipulated, but the negative persuader has also become dependent on controlling the other person, leading to a toxic relationship. Influence should only be done when it is carried out in a positive, healthy way that mutually benefits both individuals.

When you are intentionally altering the way someone thinks, you have to be careful. All of our minds work very differently, so even though you might feel like a form of manipulation is harmless, it could be doing damage to the other person. For example, many people think that belittling someone is a way to get what they want from them.

They might tell their kids that a certain sport is stupid because they do not want them to play it. The parent thinks that this tactic is a good way to get their child off the topic, but instead of the child just wanting to live up to their parent's standards, they think they are a bad person for wanting to play that sport in the first place. We have to be careful with the methods of persuasion that we choose to use on other people, especially children.

Always consider the outcome. Make sure every time you influence someone that you question if you are doing the right thing. If you are going to be gaining all the benefits and the other person is going to end up suffering, have you really done the right thing? You might have gotten exactly what you wanted, but did the other person?

Make sure that you have looked at all outcomes before you decide to try and persuade or influence. [\[c1\]](#) Make sure that you are compromising with yourself before embarking on a path of influence. Look at what they want and look at what you want and make sure to choose a path that is mutually satisfying so that no one ends up getting hurt.

We just have to make sure that we are not trying too hard to persuade ourselves that what we are doing is right. When you become a good influencer and are trained with different persuasion tactics, it becomes very simple to convince others what to do.

However, when we want to believe something, we can persuade that inner voice that questions our decisions to become silent. Sometimes persuaders become wrapped up in what they believe because they have tricked themselves into thinking something. Look at master manipulators like Charles Manson, for example.

Not only did he convince his followers that he should be idolized, but he manipulated himself into thinking so to the point that it wasn't wrong for him to persuade others to murder people. Be careful not to influence yourself too much, and try to remain as objective as possible.

Not Manipulation

Manipulation can be an abusive tactic that is not morally correct to use on other individuals. Some people are easy to manipulate, especially children,

which is why most kids grow up having the same beliefs as their parents. At an early age and throughout their developmental years, they were taught a certain ideal.

Once an idea is put in their minds, it is harder to remove, and a little voice will always be in the back of their heads reminding them of the manipulation. When you manipulate someone, child or adult, you are altering the way their brain thinks.

You can alter their chemistry, biology, and the overall function of the different parts of their brain through manipulation. You never want it to have negative results from which it is difficult to recover. Instead, you should be doing your best to try to persuade people to do good and think positively.

When you are being manipulated, the other person is trying to take something from you. Manipulation stems from individuals who are unhappy themselves. They might be depressed or anxious, and when they have run out of ways to alleviate their mental illness themselves, they look to other people to get relief.

Bullies manipulate their victims into thinking dark thoughts because they want someone else to be as unhappy as they are. It can be very lonely being unhappy with who you are, so some individuals will try and convince others to be unhappy as well. [\[c2\]](#)

Do not persuade someone about a belief that makes them feel badly about themselves just because it makes you feel better. [\[c3\]](#) Always question the ethical reasoning and outcome behind every act of persuasion in which you choose to participate.

Some people won't realize that they are participating in manipulation. People who are unhappy may not be aware of why they feel so sad. [\[c4\]](#) This unawareness can lead to unhealthy relationships filled with manipulation and mind control, and sometimes neither person involved even realizes what is happening.

The abuser is usually more aware of the manipulation tactics they are using, but not always. When two people don't have an understanding about how

their own relationship might be unhealthy, it can lead to some serious damage to their overall thought processes.

Narcissists, psychopaths, and sociopaths are expert manipulators. These people can be dangerous and are the types that occasionally become cult leaders. Once a mind has been manipulated, it becomes even easier for it to get tricked into more lies.

This ability to be continually tricked is caused by the trust that has grown between the manipulated and the manipulator, as well as the desire to prove themselves right and not have to admit that they might have made a wrong decision. People will manipulate themselves and other people into the most ridiculous scenarios just because they do not want to have to admit that they were wrong.

Mindset Needed

You need a certain mindset to be able to truly use persuasion and influence. Not everyone will be able to do so, but by recognizing that it is a skill and choosing to read this book, it is likely that you have what it takes to become a positive influencer. First off, you must look at how you have been persuaded in your life.

Look at the ways your parents, peers, lovers, and the media have influenced you. Some parts of our identity are products of the things we were taught. In order to be an influencer, you do not necessarily have to change those parts, but you do have to recognize which aspects of your identity resulted from the persuasion of others.

You have to believe in what you are influencing. It must be an objective goal, but one that you believe in order to ensure the best outcome for all parties involved. If you do not believe the words you say or the ways that you wish to influence, people will eventually figure you out. If you do not fully believe in what you have to say, you will not be able to influence others in the best way either.

You have to have full faith in your viewpoint and why it is the best outcome, mindset, or scenario in order to properly influence someone else. Do not try to convince yourself you believe in it either! True positive

influence is a product of strong knowledge that the influencer fully stands behind.

Do not get defensive if someone does not agree with you. The quickest way to get someone to disagree with you is to become angry when they do not have the same views. If someone challenges you and you get defensive, this defensiveness lets them know that you are now fighting. If you do not give them what they want and instead become combative, you have lost the chance to be influential.

Persuading others about what you believe is challenging because you are going to confront people who are set in their ways, and those people are harder to influence. Instead of becoming defensive when they question you, keep in mind that they have something to offer as well. Although you may not agree with one another, you can still learn something from them, and fighting over your views is not going to help either of you.

You can't take these situations too personally or allow yourself to be too emotionally attached to your influence. You should certainly believe in what you have to say, but do not let it define you. Have a separate identity from your influences so that you do not become too attached when someone does not agree [\[c5\]](#) .

If you are confident in what you believe, you understand that the other person just needs a little more time to consider your information. If you get too upset because someone isn't persuaded, you will discredit your belief in other ways. If you truly know what is best, then show it, and let other people realize that they may have the incorrect view. If you push too hard, you will eventually push them away, along with your chance of ever influencing them.

Chapter 2 – Behind the Scenes of the Human Mind Psychology

Everyone's brain works differently. You might be an identical twin, but your brain will still be different. The brains in our heads are just as unique as the thumbprints on our hands. This uniqueness starts with conception. Your mother and your father play a vital role in your brain development.

Your mother may have had a healthy pregnancy, or one where she smoked or drank alcohol or was just stressed out. After birth, it is up to our parents to help with the formation of our brains until we reach the ages of four to six when we start interacting with teachers and other children. Eventually we become teenagers—a really crucial time for our brains. Some teens start drinking alcohol and taking other mind-altering substances. Then we become young adults with fully formed brains, but the altering of our minds does not stop there.

Just as your stomach takes in food and your heart takes in blood, information is taken in and processed by your brain. With that information, we can do a few things. We either put it away in our long-term memory, we let it fizzle out and never think about it again, or we use it correctly and expand upon it.

Persuasion provides information that we take in and listen to, but we do not always question. When we process information, we do our best to run through all aspects of our brain to find a solution or further expand on a thought. We look at our past and relate what we learned to something we already know. The information might spark more curiosity, causing us to question it, and then can influence us to do something or persuade us to think a certain way.

When making decisions, we do our best to inform ourselves, but we do not automatically look at all the outcomes. If you have to decide between purchasing a red shirt or a blue shirt, you might first just look at the shirt you like more and go with it. You may also consider other aspects. For

example, you could consider that you have blue eyes that get brighter while wearing blue, or maybe you want to go with the red one because you do not wear that color as often.

With different decisions come different deciding factors and lengths of time in which we question aspects. When we have trouble making decisions, we look to other people to help out, which is often when we become influenced by people who are quicker with tactics that go unnoticed by us. There is a lot of room for influence in the brain, so it is important to recognize how the process works.

Our brains are very complex and can still be greatly influenced by many different factors. Like with the shirt, the color might be an instant deciding factor, or perhaps it could be the price or the location of the store. As an influencer, you know how to look at factors from all standpoints.

You can determine the deciding factors for people before they can so that you are better equipped to develop persuasive solutions. You know what someone might think before they do, so you have created a solution for them. When you appear to be someone with answers, it will help individuals who have trouble making decisions look to you for help, giving you the power to influence.

Social Interactions

Brains are wired for social interactions. We have to talk to other humans to survive, for the most part. Unless you are someone who can grow your own food, manufacture your own clothes, and build your own shelter, you likely have to talk to other people. Even if you could provide for yourself, not having someone to talk to can be extremely lonely. [\[c6\]](#)

Even though you might be able to order groceries online and chat with friends thousands of miles away, your brain is still wired for social interactions. In order to become someone who is good at influencing, you have to consider ways in which our brains work in various social settings. When you understand different locations, different people, and the effects that both have on each other, you will be better able to influence those with whom you socially interact.

In some settings, our brains will naturally react aggressively. If someone feels threatened, or if they are simply confused by a situation, they might become aggressive. They may puff up their chest, stand taller, clench their jaws or fists, or actually say something threatening to you. Or, they may react aggressively in more passive ways, such as by making rude comments or belittling you to make themselves look better.

In order to be an influencer, you cannot fight aggressivity with more aggressivity. The easy reaction would be to puff your chest bigger, flex your arms harder, and come up with a comment that is twice as rude, but that is not the path that is going to get you what you want. If someone is showing aggression, it is best to be influential in a positive way and not let them see that their aggression is affecting you. When you show them that they have no reason to be afraid or intimidated, they will lower their guard and perceive you as much more trustworthy.

Some situations cause our brains to begin thinking strategically, usually in favor of ourselves. Instead of continually worrying about how to better the situation for someone else, many people will instead think of what they need to do to get the outcome they desire. If you show other people that you are working in their favor, they are more likely to be on your side.

If you present yourself as someone strategic, the conversation becomes a game. Rather than mutually working together toward the best outcome, it becomes a competition to see who will come out on top. If you let the other person know that you are noncompetitive by engaging in positive talk and encouragement, they will be easier to persuade because they won't have to think strategically.

Our brains can also connect with other people, and this connection is when we are most influential. When people find a common way to relate to you, they will be much easier to persuade. You have convinced them that you think like them, so they will believe in what you say because they see themselves in you. However, many advertisers use relatable characters to sell products. It is important to look out for this technique in order not to be persuaded yourself.

If you want to be persuasive, you have to know how to properly react to people in any situation. It can be hard to focus in social settings; we can

become misguided and try to get a different solution than what we intended in the first place. In order to make sure that you properly have influence and persuasion over other people, ensure that you have made yourself aware of all types of people.

Before you start to persuade others, identify the types of people and their reactions in social settings and determine what you need to do to influence them. The easier the different types of people are to identify, the easier it will be to develop methods of persuasion.

How the Mind Thinks

What is “on your mind” is different than “what is in your head.” Your mind, or your conscious state, at least, feels like the main form of processing in your brain. You feel most present when you are actively thinking and doing things like reading a book or watching a movie. Then, there is your subconscious, which controls dreams.

Sometimes your mind seems so sure of itself, but that is only a result of all the other work the rest of your brain has been doing. Your network of neurons is filled with a lot of information, but it only really gets recognized with your active conscious, or what is on your mind.

Our brain organizes our thoughts without us even realizing. Some thoughts get stored in the pleasure center, and others get tossed out right away. Even when we want to shut out a memory or thought, our brain still holds onto it. It seems like life would be easier if we could just “throw away” certain parts of our brain, but we certainly can’t, and it affects how we think later on.

For most people, the worst thing that ever happened to them is still a part of their thought process, even though they might not like to think about it much. This reality is important to understand because persuasion goes deeper than simply the surface level. For instance, someone might appear to be really nice and friendly, so you think a simple comment will help you get what you want. Just because this person appears this way, however, does not mean it is true. They might end up being the opposite of what you initially thought.

Many people only care about something if it benefits them, even when it seems otherwise. People would rather talk about themselves than listen to other people, and when they do listen, they normally put themselves in that situation and try to find ways that it relates back to them. It is not necessarily a bad thing, it is just how we are wired.

It is important to remember this character trait when you are trying to be persuasive. You have to show the other person how your view benefits them. [\[c7\]](#) Give the people you want to persuade a reason to listen to you so that they benefit too.

In some instances, you can quickly persuade someone, and they will do what you want right away. A friendly smile or even a wink can get someone to do something they would not have otherwise done. Sometimes, however, we have to go a little more in depth and find ways to persuade them on a deeper level. You might have to use tactics that tap into their brain in ways that they were not expecting.

You could perhaps use influential tactics like playing on their emotions or making them relate to other people in order to make a decision. A master influencer knows how to persuade people from the surface level all the way to deeper parts that require more work.

With these complex organs in our skulls, you would think that it wouldn't be easy to convince others to do what you want. We are all so different, and we know how to think for ourselves. Many people are able to make their own decisions, but they may still look to other people for help when they can't fully make up their minds.

We all have moments when we want someone else to tell us what to do. An influencer knows how to identify these people and help lift their spirits so they can make decisions on their own. A manipulator is someone who sees these people as weak and decides to prey on their moments of insecurity so that they reap the benefits in the end. Be sure that you are an influencer, not a manipulator.

Wired for Persuasion

The mind is specifically wired to be both persuaded and influenced. Not only is it susceptible to outside influence, but it is wired with the ability to influence other people as well. If persuasion can be damaging to our psyche, then why would our brains allow it in the first place? You would think that we would have a defense mechanism in our brains to help us avoid being manipulated.

From an outsider's perspective, it may be easy to recognize when there are moments of abusive manipulation. We ask ourselves why an abused woman won't leave her spouse, for example. What we do not realize, however, is that persuasion is a part of us, and it goes deeper than just making simple decisions.

The reason why we have biological urges and powers is not exactly known, but we can make assumptions based on history. Like many other functions of the human brain, persuasion is a survival technique. Your stomach grumbles because you are hungry, signaling that you need to eat. It is a common and identifiable form of genetics that we can easily recognize.

Things like stress, anxiety, and persuasion are harder to understand, but they all serve a biological purpose as well. For example, you get anxious when you aren't doing well at work because you do not want to lose your source of income that provides for you and your family. You do not always think on this surface level, but if you dig deeper into your issues, you will find a biological urge that is being fulfilled by even the darkest emotions.

We mimic others in order to learn. When someone is walking in front of you and they fall, you look to the ground and see that it is icy, saving you from falling yourself. This reaction links back to our childhood from when we watched our parents, older siblings, and other influencers teach us how to do things. Your mom might have baked a pie a certain way, but your grandmother baked it differently. You liked your grandmother's pies better, so now you make your pies the same way. Thus, the unintentional influence that we internalize.

Our grandmother may not have meant to show that her way was better, but she did, and for that reason, we improved a part of our lives. If we had simply listened to our mom's original instructions, we would still have a good pie, but not as good as grandma's! This form of mimicry is inscribed

in our brains in order to be able to recognize the moments of positive influence and learn from them to better our lives.

Being aware of what persuasion is does not mean that we will know what is happening when we are experiencing influence because it is so natural to us. After writing this book, it is likely that I will still be susceptible to forms of persuasion. Since we were old enough to watch a commercial, we have been persuaded to buy certain items and do things we would not have done if we had not been persuaded in the first place.

Chapter 3 – What Is Influence?

Influence is the power that one has to change other people's viewpoints without using direct force. You can influence someone with your words, your appearance, and your actions, and with other things that do not include directly forcing someone to do something. You might influence groups of people, or maybe just one person. We influence our kids, our siblings, and even our parents.

Influence is sometimes obvious, but it can also be subtle. Some influence is good, but a lot can be bad. Some people try to influence others and do not manage to, while others are able to influence people without even trying. It is sometimes easier to influence someone negatively, but that is not going to be better for everyone involved.

Not all influence is intentional, especially in regard to parents. Yes, they teach children right from wrong and tell them to say "please" and "thank you," but children learn from them in many more ways than just when they are intentionally trying to teach a lesson.

You are likely influencing someone right now without even knowing it. Many older siblings do not realize how influential they are on their younger siblings, but it is necessary that they recognize their influence so they can encourage positivity. When you are a bad influence, it can be hard to change the minds of those who look up to you because they get confused about contrasting behavior.

Our first influencers were our parents or the people who raised us. Not everyone is willing to admit it, but our parents played a crucial role in the influence that helped grow us into the individuals we are today. These influencers aren't limited to just our moms and dads; older siblings, aunts, uncles, grandparents, adoptive parents, foster parents, teachers, babysitters, and anyone else who taught us anything about how to live are included too.

The way they walked, the way they used their hands, and the way their beliefs affected the way they talked all influenced us in ways we may not

even be able to identify. In order to better understand what influence actually is, pick out a habit you do and identify its influencing factor.

Maybe you really enjoy cooking, for instance. Perhaps your mom was always experimenting in the kitchen, which led to your curiosity. Or perhaps your mother and father were absent frequently, and you had to eat frozen meals and canned food to get by, and as a result, you started cooking for yourself and experimenting with food in different ways. In both instances, you were influenced, but in varying ways. Influence isn't always good, but it does not always have a bad result either. Sometimes, bad influences can alter the way that we behave, but they can also teach us how not to behave. However, positive influences are usually more effective than negative ones.

Influence in our current world is seen through social networking and other forms of media. Commercials and ads can be obvious forms of influence. Frequently, a product is placed with a person you admire, making you think that if you buy the product, you will be like that person.

[\[c8\]](#) Social media is filled with various models and personalities who regularly post pictures that are liked by many. Sometimes these personalities will slip in advertisements that go almost unnoticed, posing with a product that they like to use. It seems legitimate and as if they are really just sharing their opinions on the product.

Then, however, at the bottom of the caption, they urge you to use their code to get a discount. These social media “influencers” partner with companies to get a portion of the sales from the purchases that you and the rest of their followers make. This example is just one way that influence is ubiquitous in your life.

Long Term

Influence is something that is observed. You are taught ideas and actions, but they aren't always what influence you. You may witness one behavior, but that does not mean that you will mimic it immediately after the moment of influence. It can take a prolonged period of time to really be fully influenced by someone. You watch as they go about their day and start to

pick up on small habits. You do not instantly change your behavior because most of these things are small lifestyle changes, like the clothes you wear or the way that you talk. Influence is different from persuasion, which is more direct, but those differences will be covered later in the book.

Influence is more of a trustworthy relationship builder and not something that can happen overnight. You are influenced by people you know have their lives together. You see that what they are doing works for them, so you are more likely to participate in the same behavior. Influence is not the same as someone giving you advice.

A person may say, “I like to wear these shoes at work because they make my back feel better at the end of the day.” Just because you heard this statement does not mean that you are going to be tricked into wearing those shoes right away. Influence is when you notice that they are wearing those shoes on a daily basis and thus they complain less about their back pain. Though it is a subtle form of persuasion, you can still be an influencer without having to put too much effort into it.

At first, influence won’t always be obvious. If you move to a foreign country for ten years, you might pick up the accent without realizing it. It is only when you return to your native country that you realize how much your speech has changed.

Many people are influenced by their romantic partners. They will start to dress, walk, talk, and act like the person they are dating. This change takes place because over time, they are slowly influenced by their behavior. We are often influenced by small things that better our lives and other small improvements here and there. We also become influenced by subtle things that might just become acts of comfort.

Relational

Influence isn’t necessarily about making an exact copy of someone. Influence is about taking parts from others and applying them to your own life. You might be influenced by the way someone dresses, but you would never want to share their beliefs, or vice versa. Influence is more relational because it becomes a form of connection between two people.

[c9] Relational influence will appear in aspects of life that are similar between the influencer and the influenced. It might be on a work level, in which employees become influenced by their bosses. Your personalities might be incredibly different, but you could still have the work mindset that your boss has. Influence can help connect us in ways that we never would have imagined.

We often connect to people we are close to and other individuals who have similar interests. Influence is dependent on this connection, but it also stems from the way that your brain thinks. You are more likely going to be influenced by a person who shares the same views as you, and you are just as likely to be influenced by someone who shares your interests.

In order to be an influential person, it is important to be relatable; if you look at the top influencers in the media right now, most of them are very relatable. They might not often share their religious or political beliefs, however, because these topics can be off-putting.

Instead, they might just be a little more general about their opinions. When someone is popular with many different types of individuals, they are going to be very influential.

Their influence may be more emotional for you because you have similar perspectives. When something is part of your identity, such as your artistic expression or the type of music you listen to, it is more emotional because it is a piece of you.

When you can find people to relate to on this level, that is when you will be most influential. If you become too narrow with your interests and passions, you limit yourself in the number of people you might influence. But that is not always bad depending on your goals.

How you function in a relationship is influential on the other person as well. If you are outgoing and willing to say whatever is on your mind, these characteristics are going to influence the other person to act the same way. You will not become exact copies of each other, but you will bring out the best in them and they will do the same for you because of the subtler levels of influence.

When someone loves and admires you, you become more influential on the other person. Remember how influential you can be in your romantic relationships, or any relationship for that matter.

If we aren't careful, we may become a bad influence, causing our partner to then react in the same way. If you are closed off and not willing to share your emotions, it might influence the other person to keep to themselves as well. The more you can positively influence someone, the more they will do the same for you.

Advantages of Being Influential

It takes time to become influential, but it is possible for many people. It starts with persuasion, but that idea will be discussed later in the book. First, it is important for you to understand what influence is at its core. Becoming influential can be very advantageous for you. Since it takes longer to build up influence, it becomes steadier, and you will end up with the ability to influence people more easily.

Think of the positive leaders of the world. They have gained the trust of many individuals, and when they do something that may not seem great, people are more forgiving. People will put more weight into those who are influential because they have not been let down. Initially, they are more likely to react positively to changes from the influencer because they have been satisfied in the past.

You influence more than one person. Trying to get one person to do something can be challenging, but as you build your influence, you will be able to convince more people of something. Before you know it, you are influencing groups of people toward positive change.

You can be intelligent, dedicated, and hardworking, but if you aren't influential, it can be harder to make it to the top. Being influential helps ensure that you have what it takes to be a leader. When many people see the qualities in someone that correlate with being a leader, they will start to trust them without even realizing it.

Influence is more likely to result in change rather than regular persuasion. Influence is less scary. It is someone you trust saying, “Hey, this works for me, so it is going to work for you.”

You are more likely to trust that person because you assume what they are saying is true. You see them living an active and healthy lifestyle, so you assume that if you listen to them, you will achieve that life as well. If someone you do not know all that well tries to persuade you to do something, you are not going to be as easily influenced.

Newer people in our lives do not influence us as much as people we have known for longer periods of time. Trends might influence you, but for the most part, the biggest change comes from long-term influence.

Once you have built the reputation of being influential, you will be able to get people to do things you want more easily. People may even mimic your habits before you have had the chance to influence them!

Influential people usually live higher qualities of life. If you are consistently influencing other people toward positive change, then there is a good chance that it is “good influence.”

Rest assured that you are doing something right even if you do not feel perfect all the time. Having a community tell you that what you are doing is right and that they admire you is enough encouragement to take you further than you have already gone. You can continue to excel, promoting more influence toward a positive goal.

Qualities of Someone Who Has Influence

To be an influencer, you have to be unique. You must have the ability to think for yourself. If you think like everyone else and keep following all the same trends, you don’t stand out. You become an influencer in the first place because you are doing something different.

You are living in a way that isn’t like everyone else, so you stand out. Some people do not like change in their own lives, but that does not mean they do not admire it in others. You will find that the most influential people are often the ones who aren’t afraid to be themselves. The truer you are to your

own identity, the more you will stand out, and the more influence you will end up having.

Influencers will not be afraid to stand up for what they believe. If you go with the flow, what sets you apart and makes you influential? Sometimes influencers won't get into the dirty details about harder issues, but when it comes to questioning their character, they will always stay true to themselves.

Someone who is cowardly and bites their tongue won't have as much influence because people do not see them as trustworthy. Though it can sometimes be scary, the best way to be influential is to always stand up for what is right and be authentic.

Influencers inspire connections and know how to keep them. They can become friends with someone who would normally seem like an enemy. They are able to turn a fight into a discussion, and they know how to negotiate with the most stubborn people. They are proactive in meeting new people, and they are not afraid to share some of their feelings with them.

They are relatable and have many friends and few enemies. Influencers know how to argue, and they will still say what is on their mind, but they will not do it in a way that drives others away. They will find methods of relatability for everyone so that they can better share their ideas and actually inspire change rather than create an environment that causes people to put up walls.

If you want to be an influencer, you have to have goals in mind and clearly know what you want. We do not always have the exact answers, but we still need to set clear goals. Growing positively as a person from the inside out should be a goal for everyone. Influencers know how to actively work on themselves so they can always be the best version of themselves. Thus, you must have goals that are achievable.

Influencers will understand what matters most and become proactive with their goals. They won't just tell people what they want to do, they will actually do it. They won't "wish" or "hope," they will "do" and "achieve" so that they inspire others to do the same. Even when it seems impossible to meet a goal, influencers will still do their best to make sure that they aren't

letting down those who are inspired by them. Influencers are not afraid to let others know about their goals. They are direct with their intentions in order to continually gain the trust of others.

An influencer is well versed in how to respond in various situations, and they do not let their emotions take over. Sometimes responding angrily is what comes naturally, but an influencer can stay objective and judge how to appropriately react to a situation so that they do not let their feelings get the best of them.

Chapter 4 – What Is Persuasion?

Aristotle's *Rhetoric* identified the foundations of persuasion as ethos, logos, and pathos. Ethos is what determines the credibility of the person doing the persuasion. Logos regards the logic that goes into the persuasion, and pathos is the emotional appeal to the person who is being persuaded.

For example, say you are trying to persuade someone to try out a new diet. You would first make yourself credible by stating that you are a trained physician, or perhaps that you recently lost weight from the same diet. You would then appeal logically by stating facts about the diet, especially ones based on scientific research.

Finally, you would emotionally appeal to the audience by using relatable ideas, such as the struggle to find a swimsuit that fits. These three elements are going to be the most important factors in becoming a person who can persuade others.

Persuasion requires the persuader to look at who they want to persuade and determine what they can do or say to them in order to get their way. As the persuader, you have a goal in mind. You want to get something from the other person. Perhaps you want to persuade your boss to hire your friend. Your goal would be to convince your boss that your friend is the best candidate.

You would specifically pick out what to say to your boss until you have reached your goal. If you went about it over a long period of time, maybe by slowly bringing your friend around to get to know your boss, that tactic would be more related to influence. Persuasion refers to when you are attempting to get someone to fulfill a specific goal.

There are obvious forms of persuasion present all around us. At any given moment, you can walk down the street and see at least one advertisement that is informing you of a great deal. Maybe it is “buy one get one free,” “spend more, pay less,” or some other claim that is trying to persuade you to give the company your money.

Persuasion isn't always this obvious, but it is important to understand all levels of persuasion so we can better avoid or mimic them. Many of our friends are persuasive. They will say things like "You should go to John's party on Friday" because they don't want to go to the party alone.

We also have to be wary of the way that persuasion can be harmful. When its intention is no longer to mutually benefit both parties, there might be some form of manipulation involved. When you are the one being persuaded, it isn't always easy to identify what is happening. Sometimes you might not realize until it is too late. You might end up going to John's party and realize that it is filled with boring people you don't know, but your friend persuaded you to go because they wanted you there so that they did not get bored.

Short Term

Persuasion occurs much quicker than influence. You will usually come up with a strategy for the persuasion before as well, where influence might end up happening without even trying. In order to be good at persuasion, it is something that you have to practice. Since sometimes you only have one shot, you have to make sure that you are not going to ruin your chance to be persuasive.

Influence can make it easier to convince someone of something or to recover when you have failed to do it. If you persuade someone to do something and get caught and labeled as a manipulator, it can ruin your credibility. Not all forms of persuasion are bad, but some people are wary that you might be trying to control them, so if done in the wrong way, it can make them turn away from you.

Even a thirty-second ad can be persuasive. There is no time limit that says how quickly or how slowly you can persuade someone. You might have a year to persuade someone to move to a different neighborhood, or you might only have a minute to persuade them to sign a lease for a new apartment.

In either scenario, the right persuader would have no problem trying to convince the other person to do what they want. If something takes too

long, however, it might turn into a form of influence, or you might just have to find a different way to be persuasive.

Sometimes you do not even have to say anything; just a look can be enough to persuade. Someone might be trying on a certain outfit, and without saying that it makes them look bad, the look on your face can be enough to make them realize they should choose something different.

At the same time, we also have to look at how not saying anything can persuade someone to make a certain decision. If someone talks about wanting to do something, and you give them a simple head shake, they might be persuaded not to follow through with it at all and pursue something else instead.

Even though it can be short term, moments of persuasion can have long-term effects. If you did persuade someone to sign a lease within a short period of time, that lease could be for twelve months, and that person is now committed to a certain apartment. Before you attempt to persuade, you have to ensure that it is going to be mutually beneficial for both parties.

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Technique over Relationship

You do not have to have a close relationship with the person you are persuading. Sometimes we can persuade the sales clerk to give us a discount, or we can persuade a customer to go through with a larger sale. While influence requires a longer-term relationship, persuasion can be accomplished from the moment you meet someone.

You must be a persuasive person in order to carry through the motivation for a choice one way or another. If you come off as untrustworthy, or someone who is not authentic, it is going to be harder to be persuasive. Persuasiveness comes naturally for some, but it can certainly be learned by even the most suspicious-looking people.

Influence occurs with people who might have been admiring the influencer for a while, so it is easier to become influenced by them. Persuasion requires a little more work. You do not have that trust to fall back on, so you have to make sure that you are building an authentic case for yourself.

Give the other person a reason to trust you, and don't let them down. If you do, it will cause them to run.

There are teams hired by different marketers specifically to study persuasive techniques. Some people even do research studies to determine how someone might be easily persuaded.

Also, there are psychologists who specialize in persuasion and influence, so you can start to understand just how powerful this tool can be. It is not about building a relationship with someone. Instead, it is about finding the right technique to make sure that you are persuading properly. Having a relationship helps, but then that will start becoming a method of influence.

Think of a brand that you love that does not really advertise much. There is a good chance they built up a reputation and have been around for decades. People are influenced by their products, so they buy them. Newer companies have to do more to try and persuade you to try out their products than the ones that you already trust.

Many politicians will use persuasive techniques as well. You may not know about political candidates until they start to post their ads on television. In these advertisements, they will do whatever they can to make sure that they are persuading you to believe in them. They use techniques, strategies, and tactics backed by psychologists to persuade you.

Someone you already follow will be more influential, but for the most part, political candidates are trying to persuade you to vote for them. Next election season, look for all the methods of persuasion that people are using.

Advantages of Being Persuasive

Just like being influential, there are advantages to being persuasive. When you have the ability to quickly change someone's mind, it can be extremely beneficial. If you don't want to go to a certain restaurant, for example, you can persuade your partner to go somewhere else.

If you don't want a certain person to be invited to your party, you can persuade your friend not to invite them. If you want to see a certain movie

at the theater, you can persuade your friend that the other movie reviews were not as good. When you know how to naturally persuade others, you can better start to get what you want. Then, as you build your reputation as a persuader, you become an influencer, and people will generally be more likely to listen to what you have to say about all topics.

It is a great method for sales, so if you are a naturally persuasive person, consider this career choice. When your income is dependent on how much money someone else spends, you can persuade them to buy from you in order to boost commissions.

Some people are afraid to spend their money on material things, but you are seen as an expert in these products, so you can tell them all the good qualities they have in order to persuade them to make a purchase. Those who have a high level of success with sales and other forms of lucrative businesses are usually the most persuasive individuals. They know what it takes to get people on their team, so they are not afraid to use different strategies to try to get individuals to buy into their idea or their product.

Being persuasive means getting what you want more often. It can be easy to fall into a position where other people take advantage of you. Maybe you started off as the person always willing to take on certain tasks at work. But before you could even catch a breath, everyone started dropping their extra work on your desk. Or perhaps you became a friend who was always there to listen, but when it came time for you to find someone to talk to, no one was willing to lend an ear. After a while, you stopped getting what you wanted from other people because you no longer knew how to talk to them. Now that you are a persuasive person, however, you can finally start to get everything you deserve.

When you are persuasive, you will be less stressed out overall because you do not have to worry about getting what you want. Not being able to get what you want can cause serious anxiety, but when you are persuasive, you start to feel better. You won't have to worry as much about what you are going to do, because you will already know what it takes to get the results you desire.

Negative Stereotypes About Persuasion

Some people think that persuasion equals manipulation. If it is not handled properly, then it certainly can turn into manipulation. It is not always going to be black and white either. Sometimes you may feel like someone manipulated you when really, they were only trying to persuade you for the benefit of you both. Other times they might have actually manipulated you when you felt as though they were trying to persuade you.

When you are intentionally persuasive, there is also a sense that you are being deceptive. Some people might see forms of persuasion as manipulation because they do not like the idea that other people can have power over them. However, when it comes to persuasion as a tool, remember what was discussed in the first chapters. It can easily become manipulation if you aren't careful with it. If you are intentionally hurting another person, then it is not good, and you should stop persuasion immediately. If someone else is suffering because you wanted something from them and you got it, was it really worth it in the end?

Duress is when someone is persuaded under extreme circumstances. Duress is most commonly seen when people are put under extreme pressure to admit to something that they did not do. A person might be held in a police station for hours until they are so exhausted that they confess to something they did not commit all for the sake of going home. You will see many people withdraw confessions and police statements because they said that they only confessed due to duress. Any time a person makes an ill-informed decision, they might later state that it was caused by duress. The most infamous form of duress was seen in witch trials when women were tortured and abused until they admitted to being witches. If you look at history during that time, there were women who stated very strange and evil things and only did so because they were being brutalized. They would rather have everyone believe that they were a witch rather than endure anymore torment from the people trying to get them to confess. Duress still occurs today with many different people, and it is a criminal charge. [\[c11\]](#)

[\[c12\]](#) Manipulation tactics can cause great stress on innocent victims, and they end up having to admit to something because their minds have been twisted. However, this type of manipulation is an extreme form and does not pertain to all persuasion. It is important to understand the difference.

Persuasion should only be done when both parties are going to come out of the interaction happy, and not with just one side being fulfilled.

Coercion usually involves persuasion that is used alongside threats. You might coerce someone to participate in illegal activity by threatening to break their legs if they don't cooperate. Blackmail is similar. Someone might have some risky pictures of a person and threatens to expose them. The person being blackmailed has been persuaded by the images to do what the other person wants of them, with the other person gaining all control. Whenever someone is just doing something due to fear, it is an obvious form of coercion, manipulation, or threat that can cause serious damage down the road. Some people think that these tactics are the best way to get someone else to do something for them, but only because it is the easiest. It is not going to last, however, and eventually, in return, they will get the negativity that they put out there in the first place.

How to Overcome Negative Persuasion

In order to make sure you are not negatively using persuasion, you have to ensure that you are trying to get the right things from other people. If you need something from another person that you wouldn't feel comfortable giving yourself, then it is probably not right to ask. If you need help, persuasion isn't always going to be the best way to get there either. Sometimes you are just going to have to ask pointedly for what you need.

You must have a reason to use persuasion, and it cannot just be your main form of getting everything you want all the time. Persuasion should not be used when you might not know how to properly communicate the truth, or when the truth could end up doing more damage than good. You only want to use persuasion when it is going to result in something that is mutually beneficial for both parties. When someone is extremely persistent, do not use other tactics to try and persuade them.

Some people are good at the beginning stages of persuasion, but then when they don't get their way, they start doing the wrong things. Some people might be all smiles at first, but when they get a hint that they won't be getting what they want, they get angry and start to threaten the other person.

They might even give them ultimatums. These harsher tactics might work, but they will not last. [\[c13\]](#)

Never threaten someone to get what you want. As soon as you do, you lose all credibility. It is easy to flex muscles and cause intimidation, but it will always come back to you in the end. You might think that you convinced the person, but they could end up changing their mind once they get some clarity, and even later turn you into authority figures, such as your supervisor or even law enforcement if the threat was more intense.

Always confirm with other people that you are not making them too uncomfortable. Someone may be nodding their head and agreeing with what you are saying, but if you aren't paying attention, you might miss that they are actually really stressed. Some people might also be scared of you without you realizing. If you are an older man with a sizable shape, you may be intimidating to younger and smaller women without even trying to be. Though you have no intention of threatening or hurting another person, some people might still feel this way if you are not handling persuasion properly.

You also have to be careful with your message. If you try and tell a person to do something but they misunderstand what you are trying to say, they might do the opposite, or something completely different that creates problems. In order to ensure that you are not making anyone uncomfortable, learn how to read their body language. Someone who is fidgeting, seemingly uncomfortable in their seat, or not maintaining eye contact with you might be nervous, so they may be more agreeable than someone who appears to be comfortable.

Overall, being an influencer will help your image as a persuader. If you work on how to be a better influencer, persuasion will come along with little effort. It will not take as much effort to try and convince other people what to do when you are a seemingly trustworthy, honest, and reliable individual.

Chapter 5 – What Is the Big Difference Between the Two?

The length that it takes for change to happen is probably the biggest difference between persuasion and influence. Persuasion can happen within seconds. With the right form of persuasion, you can go from being someone who does not believe in something to a believer within minutes. On the other hand, influence takes a bit longer. You might not realize how much change has occurred until long after the initial influence. Sometimes people we would never expect become our influencers, and those we assume are good at convincing us of things are the ones who cannot persuade us. However, you can never easily identify an influencer, so you must always be aware of how you might be affected by both influence and persuasion.

Your reputation is important for both, but more so for influence. An influencer is someone who builds their reputation over time. They will share parts of their life with you while still keeping some things a mystery. They will express their thoughts and opinions on different topics, and you will start to agree with them more and more. With a persuader, a reputation can still be important. You will not be easily convinced by someone who is known to be a crook. However, you won't always have time to look into the background of a persuader, so you could still end up being convinced to do something by a person with such a reputation.

For persuasion, you must have practical skills that you grow with time and experience. There are periods of trial and error in which you might not succeed in persuading another person. However, over time, you will learn what you did incorrectly from your past behavior and know what it takes to improve it in the future. You may still have to build a reputation as well. Your persuasion might be obvious in the beginning, but with time and methods of practice, you will become subtler.

Influence tends to be natural, and persuasion is something that is learned. One typically falls into a role of influence, while one must go out of their

way to be persuasive. When we are being persuasive, our goal should be to become an influential person. When we have the ability to easily get what we want from other people, it can be much more rewarding than if we have to continually work to persuade other people to get what we want.

What Happens When You Only Have One or the Other?

If you are influential, the ability to be persuasive may still be evident, but in smaller amounts. After a while, if you no longer persuade others, you may become more of an inspiration rather than someone labeled as an influencer. Being an inspiration isn't a bad thing, but if you want to keep up as an influencer, you have to set trends, make decisions, share beliefs, and show others subtle ways of persuasion so that those who follow and look up to you still see you as a leader.

As someone who is persuasive, if you are not influential, you may appear manipulative. You never want to find yourself in a place where people believe that you are untrustworthy. If you push too hard or try to convince people to do something that will end up hurting them, they are not going to easily trust you. Instead, you have to make sure that you are only striving for outcomes that are going to help both of you in the end. When people see that you are not only someone they can trust but also someone who will help them, they will be much more willing to do what you ask of them.

One without the other can make you look inauthentic, which will result in both skills being useless. Persuasion and influence are built on trust. Someone is having trouble making a decision, or maybe their direction is a little lost. In order to make sure that you are going to get what you want in the end, you have to ensure that they are going to be willing to trust you. If they sense that you are a con artist or someone who is going to scam them, you have lost all trust and they will discredit everything you say. Once you break credibility, it can be difficult to recover, and you might forever be labeled as someone who should not be trusted.

The best way to be a well-rounded person is to make sure that you find the right balance. You have to be persuasive if you want to be influential, and

you have to be influential to get what you want. If you are too harsh, it can drive people away. If you are too sneaky with your tactics, it can make you seem manipulative or untrustworthy. If you don't try hard enough, people might take advantage of you. Everyone's balance is different, but it is important to know yours so that you can better create strategies that help you thrive.

Finding the Right Balance

When trying to persuade or influence someone, you have to make sure that you never use malice. If you threaten a person or blackmail them in any way, you might get what you want right away, but then something bad may happen. That person might back out once they get to a place where they can think for themselves, and then you are back to square one. They could also inform people of your misuse of power and destroy your credibility. They could even have serious trust issues that they carry with them into other relationships.

[\[c14\]](#) When you are not sure if you are taking advantage of someone, ask yourself if you would be okay if the situation were reversed. If your answer is no, there is a good chance that you are taking advantage of them.

Always check up on your skills in both categories to make sure that you are keeping yourself credible. Read books regarding such methods and stay up to date with what is occurring in the news and with psychological advancements that could give you more insight into how to be successfully persuasive. Thus, you will help build your skills and your overall credibility as an influencer.

Being argumentative is different than being persuasive and influential. Sometimes you just have to let the other person say their thoughts no matter how much you might disagree. If you always have to contradict everything someone else says, they are not going to be as willing to listen to you. You might be persuasive because you are logical and good at arguing, but if you are consistently combative, the other person might not listen to you just because they want to prove you wrong. Instead of correcting others, try to hear them out. Then use persuasive tactics to help them realize on their own that they are incorrect. You will find much more success with this method.

Switch up your methods of influence and persuasion as well. If you keep using the same methods repeatedly, people will become aware and start discrediting you. Some people use the same tricks to ask different people out on dates. What ends up happening, however, is that people catch on, and then your credibility is shot. Make sure that you are altering your methods from person to person and that you are not doing anything that might cause you to look deceptive.

Chapter 6 – Why You Need Both Persuasion and Influence to Succeed

Now that we have discussed the importance of both persuasion and influence and how they differ, let's get into why you need both of them to succeed. Perhaps you have already found that you are good at one, but now it is time to develop the other so that you can live to your maximum potential. If you don't build your skills in both areas, it will show in other instances not always related to persuasion and influence. The best way to make sure that you are being as influential as possible is to use persuasion, and vice versa. It might not always feel as though you need both, but you will realize how important they work together to truly get what you want.

You do not have to have power over others to survive. Some people can successfully get their needs fulfilled on their own without any help from other people. However, if you do know how to get what you want from others, that technique can really expand your life into areas that you never could have imagined. If you want to live a happy life and get what you want, then you will need to be a persuasive influencer—it is the best way to encourage others to give you the things that you most desire.

Those who are influencers are not always the type of people who should be persuading others. There are some people who are natural influencers, but that skill isn't always for the best. These people might know how to scare people into believing what they have to say, or perhaps they use other methods of fear to try and get their points across. The best way to ensure that you are spreading positivity is to use your powers for good and stop those who are misguided from spreading their bad influence onto susceptible individuals. Our job as persuaders is to make sure that people aren't manipulated but are persuaded to do better instead.

Persuasion and influence paired together will give you the necessary confidence to elicit change. If you have what it takes to recognize positivity

and encourage other people, you can really change the world on different levels.

Not everyone is going to find that power, but those who do encourage global change were also influenced by someone. Though you might feel helpless sometimes, remember that influencing one person can mean influencing another, and so on and so forth. Before you know it, your words could travel across the world to someone else. All it takes to see real positive change is the altering of one person's mind.

Though you might not be the one to inspire thousands of people, you might inspire twenty, and they each could go on to inspire twenty more, and then twenty more, and before you know it, many are forever changed by the ideas that you thought of in the first place.

You Can't Have One Without the Other

There is a difference between people who are inspiring and people who are influential, and you are reading this book because you want to learn how to influence. You may not be able to walk away from this book being persuasive, but by now you are more aware of those powers, so you can look for them in instances that you might have otherwise ignored. Recognizing these instances will help improve your own methods while also strengthening your ability to protect yourself from other people's negative persuasive techniques. When we are influential ourselves, it becomes much more difficult for people to take advantage of us.

Part of being an influencer is using small methods of persuasion. It starts by convincing one person to believe in you. From there, more people will follow, and before you know it, you have become an influencer who a lot of people admire. You might be the person they come to for advice, or perhaps you are the friend who everyone wants to have in their life. Either way, it all started with one small instance of persuasion that grew into something bigger.

If you continually try to persuade others but do not have an influential life, people are not going to be as attentive. If you consistently tell people what to do, but your own life is a mess, people most likely won't listen to

anything you have to say. To be a better persuader, you have to put yourself in a position that other people desire. This theory is used in the basic method of advertising referenced earlier. When you want to sell a product, place it with someone attractive. People may buy that product with the hope of becoming attractive too. If you live an influential life and show other people that you know what it takes to be happy, they are more likely to listen to your persuasions.

Once you find the balance of both, they will become natural to you. An influencer usually knows how to be persuasive without even trying, simply because they have gotten to a point in their life where they know what is best. [\[c15\]](#)

Persuasion Comes Before Influencing

As you become more persuasive, you will become better at being influential. Some people are born into influential roles. Look at Kylie Jenner, for example, or other people who were seemingly born into a role of persuasion. They didn't do much other than be children of the wealthy or well known. People started to admire them, perhaps because they wanted to be like them, so these people ultimately became influencers.

Most of us aren't born into insanely wealthy families, so we do not have the luxury of being a natural influencer. For everyone else, it will start with smaller instances of persuasion. You will not only have to let others know that you believe you know best, but you must show that you actually do. You persuade people in small ways, maybe at work by giving advice where it is needed. Eventually, you become the person they go to for final decisions and other monumental moments that might have otherwise passed you by had you not been initially persuasive.

An influencer becomes who they are because they are able to persuade others. They have the ability to make people see their perspective, or just a different perspective. When someone is able to change one's perspective, they stand out from the crowd. As stated previously, a person is an influencer because they go against the current trend and aren't afraid to stand out. When a person is authentic, it can take them a long way in terms of the perception of other people. Some people are lost in their lives and

need to look to other individuals for inspiration. If you are an influencer, you step into that role and become someone who inspires individuals to make different decisions.

If you can't be persuasive, you won't be influential. You might be admirable or inspirational, but you will not actually encourage anyone else to change. People may still like some of your qualities, but they won't really listen to you when it matters. Those who don't believe in what they have to say will be individuals who don't excel in persuasion. In order to make sure that you have what it takes to influence other people, you have to make sure that you believe in yourself and the things that you have to say. [\[c16\]](#)

Before you can become a hugely influential person, you have to be in a state of pre-influence. This state is when you work on yourself the most, creating an image that people can rely on and trust. During this state of pre-influence, you will have to determine your audience or the people you plan to persuade. Thus, you can better come up with methods of inspiration. For example, if you want to appeal to everyone, what parts of your life might be controversial? If your inspiration is going to be more specific, do you need to improve on certain skills and hobbies? This status of pre-influence will also include bouts of small persuasion when you can really get a good feel for what works and what does not.

How to Master Both Effectively

Consistency is going to be important in mastering both influence and persuasion. If you aren't someone who can be reliable, people are not going to trust you as easily. Humans thrive on consistency. That is why most people work from morning to afternoon, why weekends are free to many, and why many businesses stick to certain hours. When you can be consistent, you can be trusted. If you are not someone who can be trusted, you will not be someone who is influential. Consistency is important in all aspects of influence, so make sure that you aren't sloppy with your methods. If you aren't being consistent with your ways, people will notice that you are trying too hard to influence them.

You have to be someone who people want to hear. If you are nagging others, displaying an attitude that you know what is best, or convincing

them using any sort of threat or negativity, people are not going to want to listen to you. If you anger them, it will just drive them away. For instance, many parents have trouble with their teenagers. Teens are at a susceptible stage in their life as they are experimenting with independence and boundaries. When parents put strict rules on their kids and yell at them for doing things that are wrong, the kids usually lose authority, and they end up wanting to do that bad thing their mom or dad told them not to do just to be a little rebellious. To make sure that you are not falling into this trap with anyone, you have to ensure that you are the type of person that others want to hear. Being this type of person comes with respect. Do you respect them? If you don't and instead belittle them, it is going to be harder to get their attention. They might listen to you just to appease you, but if you are too hard on them initially, they will not believe anything that comes out of your mouth.

Start small and build your way to the top. People who try too hard immediately are transparent. If you show that you are desperate to get what you want, it makes you appear as if you don't have your life together, and people will be less likely to become influenced by you. Play it cool no matter how hard that might be. When others see your relaxed attitude, they will be more likely to listen to your methods of persuasion.

Believe in yourself. If you do not buy into what you are saying, people are eventually going to sense it. Do not try to persuade a group of people to do something if you don't undoubtedly think that what you believe is best. Sometimes we are unsure of our own thoughts, and that is fine, but that is not the time when we should be trying to convince others to do something. Influence can be powerful, so if you do something that you are not sure of, it can have serious consequences. Do not be someone who tells people how to live, only to backtrack over your words later and admit that you might have made a mistake. It is easy to change your own mind, but it will not be as easy to undo damage done by misguided influence or persuasion.

Methods of Practice

Persuasion comes from confidence, so if you do not have it in the beginning, it is only going to make it harder to be persuasive later. Do whatever you have to do to grow your confidence. You are going to have to

do a lot more than read a book. We have been persuaded to hate our bodies by many different companies in order to profit off our insecurities. People say your hair is too dry, so you buy expensive conditioner. Others will make wrinkles look scary, so you buy expensive ointments to fill the cracks. Remember that you were not born that way; you were taught to hate yourself. Make sure that you exude confidence and know how to have a higher level of self-esteem to make yourself credible. If you don't even believe in what you have to say, why should anyone else?

Look for ways you can persuade people in your daily life. Next time you go shopping at a boutique, practice persuasion by seeing if someone can give you a discount. You can also try going to different garage sales or art shows, as there are opportunities for persuasion there too. Remember that negotiation is important, but it is not interchangeable with persuasion. Instead of improving your negotiation skills, try to see if there are persuasion practices you can use to help you get what you want.

Be careful not to be someone who is becoming too manipulative. It is not about how you can get someone to do something for you. It is more about how you can get them to see things from your perspective so that they want to do it for you. You may persuade someone to do something for you that benefits you a little more sometimes. Remember to find balance. Help others out with your influential abilities as well. Try to convince your boss to not only give you a raise but to help out everyone in your department too. You can have moments where you are a little selfish, but you should never fully take advantage of another person. Just because someone is easily manipulated, it does not mean that we have to take advantage of that quality. Instead, we try to build on their confidence and inspire them to improve from within. It is better that we help people who are more susceptible to persuasion in a positive way before they get wrapped up in a relationship with a narcissist or a psychopath.

Next time you find yourself at the beginning of an argument, stop and take a breath. Instead of fighting, try to figure out how you can persuade someone. It is difficult to keep our emotions under control, and you might have moments where you just want to scream at the other person and tell them that they are wrong. However, screaming is not going to help you on your path to getting what you want. Instead of immediately becoming combative

and argumentative, see if there are ways to influence positive change. If you approach them with a neutral attitude, rather than like a soldier fighting a war, they are more likely to buy into your ideas and openness for discussion.

Now, let's delve deeper into the principles and core qualities of both persuasion and influence that you will need to find success.

Chapter 7 – Principles of Persuasion

Reciprocity is one of the major forms of persuasion. It is in reference to the feeling of needing to return something when something is given to you. If you invite someone over to your house, they will feel the need to invite you over to their home afterward. When you give someone a compliment, you can see that people will normally give you a compliment as well.

If you want to get something from someone else, try to offer them something similar first. It can be as simple as trying their food at a restaurant. Next time the server brings out two plates, offer your date a bite of your dish. They will likely end up offering you a bite as well.

[\[c17\]](#) **Scarcity** is the second principle. If you make yourself unavailable, then you will become even more desired. Scarcity is a tactic that many people use for online dating. They think that if they rarely respond, then they will make themselves more desirable, and the other person will try even harder to mend the relationship. This result is certainly true in some cases, but people will get bored and move along, so make sure you are still giving the people what they want.

Think of one of your favorite brands. At one point in time, the company probably came out with a “limited edition” item. This release is more often than not just a marketing tactic to try and get many buyers all at once. Sometimes limited edition items become popular enough that they become staples, and the company probably just used the “limited” status as a way to test out their product.

Scarcity is also used when people say that they only have a few items or spaces left. If you are a hair stylist, you might tell your clients to make their appointments quickly because you only have a few spots open. Many people will feel the pressure to schedule, so they will make an appointment even though they might not have been considering doing so previously. If you want to be persuasive, try using this tactic to help you get what you want.

Authority is important in persuasion, but it cannot be confused or misconstrued. Some people assume that authority comes with power, and that power equals strength. Many people will yell, scream, fight, and be angry in an attempt to look as though they have authority over others. This tactic can work, but not in a respectable way.

In terms of persuasion and influence, authority refers to someone's credentials. A person will use their past certifications, training, college degrees, and other forms of quantifiable authenticity to prove their credentials. You will hear people say, "I'm a doctor" when describing a health product, which gives them the authority to decide that it is good for your health.

You will often see toothpastes marketed as "the toothpaste your dentist uses" or something along those lines as an attempt to give authority over your decision. If you want to use this persuasive principle, try finding what your authority might be. If you are interviewing for a position, you might mention that you are a college graduate or a pre-med student to help remind those who hold more power than you do that you have a level of authority as well.

Consistency is crucial for anyone who wants to have persuasion over others. We have already talked about consistency for other reasons, but it is important to know that it is crucial to becoming a persuasive individual.

Consistency is a good skill to have because it makes people comfortable with you. If you are erratic, it can make you seem unapproachable, unrelatable, and somewhat scary.

In order to use consistency as a form of influence, ensure that you are sticking to your morals, beliefs, and overall identifying factors. Also, find a balance so that you do not become too predictable. If you do become a person who is too predictable, you will not have as much influence over people, resulting in less of a chance to be persuasive as well.

Being liked is an important aspect for those who want to be persuasive. The most liked people are those who give compliments, cooperate, and are relatable. Figuring out how to be liked is challenging, and it is something

that triggers us back to junior high when we were hoping not to be the last called when picking teams.

Being liked as an adult can be easier because most of us are more forgiving and less judgmental and harsh than we were in our younger years. The most liked people are those who are complimentary. However, you do not want to be someone who gives people compliments too often. It can make you seem desperate for approval, which in turn will make you less trustworthy and someone who is not as talented in persuasion.

Still, compliments help win over the other person. Make sure your compliments are natural. Do not just give compliments because you are trying to be persuasive or people will catch on and call you out for your phony behavior.

Others like people who can cooperate. If you are someone who shows that you are willing to help out, people will be much more likely to listen to you. When you can collaborate and compromise with many different people, it shows that you are someone with whom it is easy to get along, which will lead you to become a person who can easily influence others. When you are relatable, you seem more approachable as well.

For people who are the biggest influencers, relatability is huge. Those you are trying to persuade want to see themselves in your shoes. When they can look at you and find moments of connection, they are going to be much easier to persuade.

When it comes to persuasion, **consensus** is the last thing others will consider. They will make as many informed decisions as possible on their own, but when all else fails, they will look at what everyone else thinks before making their final decision.

For businesses, people will go online and look at reviews to determine if they want to give you their money or not. On a more personal level, people might ask their friends if they know you so they can get a sense of whether they should like you. Though it is important to have a connection with the person you are persuading, in order to be a good influencer, you also want to make sure that the general consensus agrees on your likability and credibility.

The Concepts That Make It Work

The amplification theory is another concept that allows persuasion to work. If you really build something up, people are more likely to be persuaded. This technique can work if you amplify something negatively as well.

Making someone feel badly about something they like in order to prove your point or give yourself validation can work, but why would you want to use this strategy? People will initially be influenced by you, but if you continue to make others feel badly about their decisions, they will eventually look to someone else.

Asking for something small is another good concept in helping you get what you want later. If you want to persuade someone to let you borrow a hundred dollars, for example, you might first ask if you can borrow twenty. It is as if you have eased them into asking for the bigger favor later on.

Alternatively, ask for something so ridiculous that they say yes to your second request. If you ask them to dog sit for a month, many people would be opposed to the thought. If you then ask them to dog sit just for the weekend they are much more likely to say yes. [\[c18\]](#)

Anchoring is a technique that makes someone else think they are getting away with a great deal. Stores like Kohl's and Macy's seem like they are always having some sort of sale. They use anchoring as a method to get you to buy their clothes. Stores plan sales because they know that the illusion of saving money is what gets people to spend their cash.

You can use this method of anchoring as a persuasion tactic as well. When working with a client, if you know it takes you five days to complete a project, you might tell them you need seven. That way, you work hard to get it done in four days and they are impressed.

In persuasion, relatability and unity are also important. We look at celebrities and wonder where their level of relatability is. Ultimately, they seem like they are perfect, but the top influencers are the ones who are not afraid to be vulnerable.

They will show pictures of themselves not looking their best or share moments when they were feeling a little down in order to seem more relatable to their fans. They still don't share all the dirty details, but they have given enough away to keep people coming back because they seem so relatable.

Chapter 8 – Methods of Persuasion

Framing is a method of persuasion that requires you to create a perception of something that will alter someone else's reality of that same situation. Just think of it exactly how it sounds. You could take a picture that is five feet tall and three feet wide and cut it down to a three by three picture, completely altering its original look. This is a method of persuasion that can help when you want to let someone know about a situation that you are trying to encourage or discourage them about.

Mimicry and mirroring are important methods of persuasion as well. They can start simply by looking at the other person's body language. If they seem like they are open, sitting relaxed on a couch, you are going to want to do the same rather than standing rigidly across the room. When you can mirror their behavior and match their body language, it makes you much more relatable, and they will be more likely to listen to what you have to say.

Being scarce and building curiosity are important methods that can help persuade many people at once. We already talked about scarcity, but part of that technique is creating a level of curiosity that is left for everyone else to fill in. When you keep people waiting, they will start to fill in the blanks. They will wonder about the situation, trying to see if they can guess correctly. This wondering builds tension, and they are going to be much more likely to be persuaded once you finally reveal what you have been holding back from them.

Timing and consistency are also important methods of persuasion that will help you be powerful. Consistency is important, but timing also has to be right as well. Someone who is good at persuading knows that persuasion can't just be practiced at any moment. You have to make sure that people are in the right mood. Others have to be ready and open to persuasion in order to make sure that it occurs without any problems. If you ignore timing, then you could be ignoring the needs of the people you are influencing.

Strategies and Tactics of Persuasion

Start small with your strategies of persuasion. Do not try and convince people of something huge right away. First, test the water and see where you need to improve. Sometimes you might think you know exactly what to say in your head, but then when you get to the actual situation, you completely choke up. Instead of starting big, remember to find small instances of persuasion. See if you can convince your roommate or friend to do something small. When you “win” these small moments of persuasion, they will help you build your confidence so you are in the right mindset for the next time you have to do some convincing.

Stay strong with your beliefs and stick by what you say. If you are true to yourself, no one will ever have to judge your authenticity. When we show signs of deception, people are not going to be willing to listen to what we have to say. If they don't think they can trust you to be yourself, they certainly won't have faith that you are making the correct decision for them. It can sometimes be challenging, but we have to make sure that we are doing our best to be trustworthy individuals on whom other people can rely.

Use small and subtle compliments. Do not be a person who only gives compliments as currency. You do not need to give a compliment every time like clockwork but try pointing out the things people are wearing when you see them. A simple “I love those shoes!” can really take you a long way. Don't only compliment people on their appearance either.

When someone tells you a story, you can tell them that they have the best stories or that they always make you laugh. When discussing ideas with others, especially clients or other coworkers, do not be afraid to compliment them on their intelligence. “That's a really good idea,” “I'm glad you're on my team,” or “I never would have thought of that” are excellent examples of compliments.

These small compliments can really take you a long way with persuasion. You have the likability factor, and they will enjoy impressing you because they will expect a compliment that boosts their confidence. People will be much more likely to agree with what you are saying. By slipping in comments at random times, they won't seem planted.

Do not push too hard, and retreat when you notice small instances of “winning.” If you have to persuade someone about a big project, you do not want to push all at once. If you put a lot of pressure on them, they can crack and pull away altogether.

Take bigger moments of persuasion slowly. Start by planting one small idea, then wait until your next meeting to take it to the next level. Instead of waiting for moments of weaknesses to retreat, such as when they don’t seem interested or if they are showing skepticism, stop the persuasion when things are going well.

This advice may sound counterintuitive, but it can actually be helpful in making sure they do not become aware that they are being persuaded. When they see you handling a situation casually, it puts less weight on the outcome. They won’t be as afraid to submit because they aren’t feeling immense pressure from you.

Make sure you are assessing the other person first. Everyone is different, and even though that is an obvious statement, it is something that many people forget. Before you try influencing entire teams at a time, make sure that you are still specifying persuasion to specific individuals so that everyone feels important. Once you have more people on your side, it becomes easier to be an influential person overall, and that is when you can really start to alter the minds of groups of people at a time.

Real-Life Examples

Let’s look at a strategy you can use in your romantic life. Perhaps you are a woman ready to have a baby with your husband. The two of you have talked about having kids before, and you know that he is interested, but you want to have a baby a little earlier than you both originally planned. Instead of introducing the idea to him all at once, you might use a subtler method of persuasion to try and get him on your side.

You would first try framing a situation. Perhaps you tell him a story about a friend with a baby and how happy she and her husband are. You would leave out the parts about staying up all night, the constant crying and numerous diapers. Instead, you would talk about the cute things that the

baby does and how much joy it brings to the family. Remember to stay strong with your belief about having a baby sooner.

If he says that he isn't interested in having a baby too soon, instead of backing off right away, tell him that it is never too soon to have a baby. If you backtrack, it is going to make him realize that he holds the power in the decision and has the final say. Do not let this situation happen! Be strong and get what you want, even if it takes more than one method of persuasion.

When persuading a friend, there are some strategies that are better than others. Let's look at the method of scarcity in an example. Say you want to persuade your friend to move to a different city with you at the end of the month. They seem like they are mostly okay with that idea, but they still need that one last push to really make the final call.

Now is the time to use a method of persuasion on them. If you make them feel like there is a sense of scarcity in the decision, they will be more likely to jump on the opportunity. Start small by reminding them that it is peak real estate season and that the next few months are going to be prime time if they want to get a good apartment. If that isn't enough, try reminding them how short life is and how they have to start making decisions for their future now! If you can convince them that there is a sense of urgency, they will be much more likely to make that final decision in your favor.

In the business world, your persuasion will be extremely important. For this example, let's pretend that you are a salesperson in a department store, working at the jewelry counter. You need to make another sale to reach your goal for the night, and you see a gentleman who has been looking at an expensive watch. You see that he is clearly interested in it, but something is holding him back from making the final decision.

This type of situation is when compliments and mimicry really come in handy. You might first warm up to him by saying that you like his suit or perhaps his hair. You can then inform him that the watch would look great on him and encourage him to try it on.

Look at his body language and do what you can to relate to it. If he seems nervous, be relaxed so that he knows he can trust you. If he is relaxed, do

not appear nervous or else he might not be able to trust you. With a few more compliments and matching body movements, the sale will be yours.

You might think you would want to go for something more obvious in this situation, like using the scarcity method, but as a salesperson, you never want to be too obvious. If you relate to him on a personal level, it is no longer a business transaction and instead one that is mutually beneficial to both parties. He sees you as someone who is a fashion expert who wants to help others find new items, not as a person behind a counter trying to make a sale.

Chapter 9 – Principles of Influence

The top principle of influence is, of course, persuasion. If you cannot persuade others, you will find it much harder to become a person who has any influence over people. One cannot exist without the other, so make sure that you are first practicing methods of persuasion before you try to become an influencer. It is not an easy task, and many people might not make it to this status. Being an influencer is really the end goal of most forms of persuasion. It requires less work and is a more passive form of persuasion.

To be an influencer, you must be active. Few situations are more discouraging to other people than a person who says they are going to do something but then never ends up doing it. You have to get out there and show the world that you are there to live in it, and then people will start to admire your enthusiasm. They will see someone who they want to be—an active person who is always trying new things and making new memories.

When you stick to your word and just do different tasks in general, you have checked off the likability factor and also made yourself consistent. This behavior is going to make you more trustworthy in the end and help you build your way as an influencer.

Influencers share parts of themselves with others, but they do not overshare. You will have to start giving some insight into your vulnerabilities and let people know that you are human. This vulnerability gives them the idea that you are relatable. People will see that they are not alone with their flaws and that you are not at an unachievable level.

If you overshare, however, it can start to discredit you. People will wonder, if you don't have your life together, why they should listen to your persuasion in the first place. At the same time, it will break the illusion that you are someone to be desired, making you less influential overall.

Those who want to be influencers also have to be competitive. They have to look at others who are influencing and determine what it is that they can do better. As an influencer, you should not be too actively competitive.

Comparing yourself to others can sometimes be extremely damaging. What you will want to do, however, is to remember that other people help to create certain standards, so you should do your best to make sure you are standing out from everyone else.

Ultimately, influence is derivative from confidence and the ability to be a leader. If you believe that you are the best, others will start to believe the same thing as well, simply because they trust that you know what you are talking about. If you can lead others in the right direction, more people will end up following you, and soon, you will be living the life that you have been wanting!

The Concepts That Make It Work

A sense of mystery is important when influencing others. As stated previously, mystery allows people to fill in the blanks. When you leave them wondering, they are going to stay invested in you. If you leave them hanging for too long, they eventually go away. If you use your methods properly, however, you can keep people interested in your life long enough for them to become influenced by you.

Influencers also need to ensure that they are a little scarce. Someone who is always present becomes someone on whom you can rely. Consistency is good, but too much of it may make people take you for granted. If you are always available, people will either get used to your presence or stop reaching out. When you make yourself seem scarcer, it makes you more exciting.

Think of how many people live secretive lives that leave their fans wanting more. Many celebrities will go into hiding or take a social media break to create mystery and wonder before they drop a new album or movie. You can almost be certain that an influencer who takes a break or makes themselves scarce is only preparing for you to put more money toward what they created whenever they might decide to return.

A general attitude is better than a more specific one. If you can be a relatable person to all sorts of people, you will have a larger influential following, which will help you get more of what you want. Having an

individual identity and specific sense can also help people gain interest in you, but you just have to decide how much influence you have when defining your different beliefs and ideas.

Temptation can sometimes be the most powerful concept of influence. People simply want what they can't have. Think about dieting, for example. You might go a week without fast food without even realizing it, but when you say, "Okay, I'm starting my diet on Monday and that means absolutely no fast food," the first thing you want on Monday is a big greasy cheeseburger from the drive-through.

Make people want you, whet their curiosity, and have them coming back for more.

Chapter 10 – Methods of Influence

One method of influence is to make sure that you apply facts and use logic. If you have arguments and visions based in scientific fact that can't easily be disputed, you will be a much more influential person. Those who only have beliefs based on faith can be just as influential, but it takes longer to build a following and it usually won't be as large. When you use proof over emotion to make a point, you are going to have more people who are ready and willing to listen to what you have to say.

A necessary method of influence is to be relatable. You want to appeal to people's beliefs, morals, and the things that they value. Never forget to keep yourself grounded and humble.

You have to be confident and have your own beliefs, but sometimes you need to make decisions based on the overall group mentality. An influencer knows how to stand out from the crowd and be true to themselves. At the same time, they still have to be appealing, and sometimes that means just giving into the group demand. It might not always be what is most fun, but it is important in making sure that you keep an interested and invested following.

The best method of influence is to be likable. If people like you, they are going to listen to you. This method may seem obvious, but many people are willing to embarrass themselves or be controversial all for the sake of fame. They might post things they don't fully believe in just to get a negative reaction that stirs up drama. This technique is one way to get a following, but that does not mean you are going to be an influencer. If you want to elicit positive change and spread your ideas from one person to the next, you have to make sure that people like you.

Specific Strategies and Tactics of Influence

Pressure is the first strategy of influence that you can try using. This strategy is similar in technique to scarcity, but it does not always have to be

a method that involves convincing people that sources are lacking. You might put on pressure by stating how important something is. If you want to influence others to purchase donations in your name, you might tell them how much it means to you and how grateful you would be if they could help out. You put pressure on the other person by letting them know that your emotions are at play. They will be more likely to help than if you hadn't put any weight on the situation.

A beginner's influence strategy is coalition and collaboration. When you can get other people on your side, it will be easier to get even more people on your team. Influencers have to stand out from the crowd, but that does not mean you can't still get help from the groups of people around you. Find people who are similar to you, or are at least relatable, and look for ways that you can get together to work toward mutual benefits.

Influencers might use the strategy of fulfilling a promise. "If you follow me, I will provide this for you." The best influencers offer an answer to the people who look up to them. Religious leaders let their followers know that they will be providing salvation. Celebrities promise that if their fans support them, they will release new music or win the game.

Real-Life Examples of Influence

We looked at smaller examples of persuasion in the last chapters, so now let's see how influence can help you live a better life. Remember to start with the methods of persuasion before you become an influencer. These next steps occur after mastering persuasion.

For our first example, let's look at a political election. Elections are a very influential time, and many people will be torn while trying to figure out their vote. A candidate who uses facts and logic in their argument is most likely going to be more successful than one who just keeps talking. [\[c19\]](#) People are usually more influenced when they tell them that nine out of ten people believe this fact (or something along those lines) rather than just saying a lot of people do.

For another example of influence, let's look at the way a social media influencer might go about their business. Though they need to have a separate identity that sets them apart from the rest, it is still good to base

some decisions in consensus and on what the group mentality wants. If someone feels like their followers are dropping, they might look to their fans to figure out what they need to do.

They could use a poll system to ask people if they want new content or just more of the old stuff. They can look at comments and read reviews to determine what areas they can use to influence people. Rather than blatantly saying what they are going to do, they can be subtler about it so that they elicit the highest possible amount of influence over their fans.

Chapter 11 – The Keys to Putting Persuasion and Influence Together

Remember that in the beginning it is going to be a little harder for you to gain influence over people as influence starts with smaller forms of persuasion. Do not be afraid to practice on your friends and family. The most important thing to remember is to never have malicious intent. If you do, people will notice, and it will come back to haunt you in the end.

Being an influencer is all about appealing to others, and persuasion requires a little more authority. Remember that you have to be persuasive, and then the influence will come along. When you have built yourself up as a positive persuader, in future negotiations you can say, “I haven’t let you down yet!” As long as you keep up your level of trust with other people, your credibility will grow.

In the first sections of chapters 7–10, we reviewed the basics of persuasion and influence and explained what made them so important. Write down at least one method, strategy, or tip from each section that you think will be the easiest for you to do. When you have the best concepts pulled, you will be able to better see how they can relate to each other.

To get the biggest impact from both, you have to make sure that you are looking at what works best for yourself and for the audience that you are going to be influencing. You should consider yourself first so that you do not have to compromise your beliefs. Then look at what the people want because they are going to be the ones you are influencing.

Take the best concepts of each and manipulate them to your benefit. Not every method of influence or persuasion is going to work for you, so make sure that you are catering the methods to yourself. Be sure to practice everything we discussed because sometimes you might not realize how good you are at a method until you are out there in the field.

Chapter 12 – How to Have Influence Without Authority: Is It Possible?

Authority is just one component of influence. You need to have credibility, and it can come with your authority to make decisions and have moments of persuasion. Authority might be your college degree or title.

Authority might be helpful at first, but it will only take you so far. If you have too much authority over others, it might be intimidating, which may destroy your relatability. People sometimes fear those who are too authoritative, so instead of being positively influenced, they end up scared.

Authority is not the sum of influence. Also, you should never be aggressive or intentionally intimidating. It is good to instill a bit of fear in those from whom you want respect, but it should be done in a way that does not make them scared of you. Instead, they should know that you have high standards and that you will not take any negativity from them.

Common Perceptions of Authority

Some people believe that authority is an automatic ticket for influence. The reality is, most of the time, it isn't. If you force people to do something they don't want to do, they will only grow to resent you, especially when they have no way of fighting back.

Coercion and duress are situations that use authority as a scare tactic. If you make someone do something because they are scared of what will happen when they don't, you are likely being authoritative with them. Some people scare more easily than others, but you should still strive not to instill fear in anybody.

[\[c20\]](#) When you are knowledgeable about a subject, you won't need authority to influence someone. People will see your authenticity, and sometimes, that is enough to keep you credible.

People can usually see through scare tactics and know that you are hiding something. They won't argue with you if you are intimidating them or yelling, but they will see that you are desperately fighting for power.

However, you do not want to make yourself too vulnerable, so ensure that you have the right balance.

Sincerity, Care, and Getting What You Want

If you use sincerity and show that you care, you can accomplish what you want in a way that does not require authority as the main form of communication. People will always respond much better to those who are authentic, loving, caring, and open to them.

You never want to put yourself in a place where you are abusing power. It is easy to get lost at the top, especially when you are not prepared for power. What you have to remember, however, is that you owe it to the people who helped you get there in the first place to make sure that they are taken care of too.

Say you do have everything you ever hoped for. When you have made it to the top, are you really going to be happy? You will likely be too lonely because you have pushed everyone away.

Chapter 13 – With Great Power Comes Great Responsibility

With power comes great responsibility, so you have to make sure that you are using it correctly. Don't abuse your abilities to be persuasive and influential. [\[c21\]](#)

Remembering Motivation

Always keep motivation in mind when navigating through the world of persuasion and influence.

Persuasion and influence aren't simply given. Some people might be more naturally persuasive, but for the most part, you have to work toward this skill to come up with the best possible methods.

Do not take these abilities for granted. Do not let yourself become comfortable with getting what you want all the time but leaving the other person empty-handed. Persuasion and influence might sometimes hold more weight on your side of the scale, but you should still make sure that everyone is coming out of the situation happy.

Imagine what the world could be like with people like you who can use the responsibility for good.

Conclusion

Throughout this book we have discussed what you need in order to become a persuasive individual. It is not something you can do right away and will take a little bit of practice. The more you can be a persuasive person, the easier it will be to become an overall influencer.

The human psychology is important to understand for becoming a persuasive and influential person. When you can better figure out how our brains work, it will be easier to understand how to persuade them.

There is a big difference between persuasion and influence, and you need to understand it so that you can better figure out your path to becoming persuasive. Remember that you are in control.

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- [\[c1\]](#) Interrupts flow of narrative.
 - [\[c2\]](#) Repetitive.
 - [\[c3\]](#) Repetitive.
 - [\[c4\]](#) Unnecessary. Doesn't add to argument.
 - [\[c5\]](#) Phrase used repetitively.
 - [\[c6\]](#) Addressed in next paragraph.
 - [\[c7\]](#) Vague and repetitive.
 - [\[c8\]](#) Unnecessary. Adds wordiness.
 - [\[c9\]](#) Disrupts flow of narrative.
 - [\[c10\]](#) Vague.
 - [\[c11\]](#) Repetitive.
 - [\[c12\]](#) Assumption.
 - [\[c13\]](#) Assumption.
 - [\[c14\]](#) Repetitive.
 - [\[c15\]](#) Assumption.
 - [\[c16\]](#) Vague.
 - [\[c17\]](#) Unnecessary. Adds wordiness.
 - [\[c18\]](#) Unnecessary. Adds wordiness.
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